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PT LIMS User Manual

(Proficiency Testing Laboratory Information Management System)

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VETQAS®, Animal and Plant Health Agency, College Road,
Sutton Bonington, Loughborough, Leicestershire, LE12 5RB, UK

03000 600003 | vetqas@apha.gov.uk | www.aphascientific.com

APHA is an Executive Agency of the Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs and also works on behalf of the Scottish Government, Welsh Government and Food Standards Agency to safeguard animal and plant health for the benefit of people, the environment and the economy.





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LOGGING IN

HOW TO LOG IN

Click [here](#) to log into PT LIMS. Use the username and password that were emailed to your registered email address, when your account was first set up.

WHAT TO DO IF YOU HAVE FORGOTTEN YOUR DETAILS

If you have forgotten your username, please email vetqas@apha.gov.uk.

If you have forgotten your password enter your username and click the Reset Password button on the log in page. A new password will be sent to your registered email address. Only the primary email address for the participant will receive password reset emails.

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Working to safeguard animal and plant health

APHA Homepage Main Menu Help

APHA Science Services

Login

Please enter your APHA Science Services Username and Password and click on Login.

Username:

Password:

LOGIN

Forgotten your password? Enter your Username only and click on Reset Password to request a new password to be sent to your registered email address.

[Reset Password](#)

Rice, Rice Everywhere!

If you require further assistance, please contact the administrator who issued your Login details.

HOW TO CHANGE YOUR LOGIN DETAILS

To change your login details, when you first login from the screen above you will see the screen below. Click on the Change Password link at the bottom of the main menu page to change your password. Please note that your confidential Lab ID number cannot be changed.

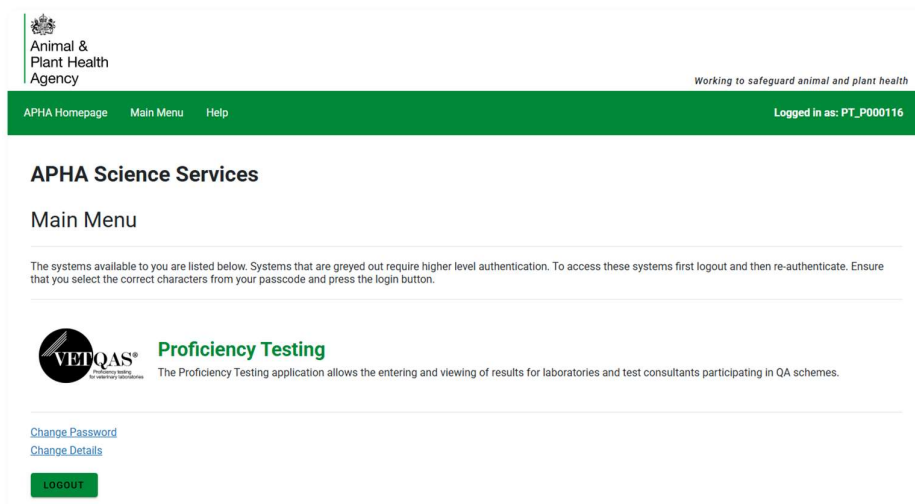
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HOW TO UNLOCK YOUR ACCOUNT

Your account will be locked if there are five failed login attempts. To unlock your account please email vetqas@apha.gov.uk

PARTICIPANT

If you are logged in using a participant's details [PT_Pxxxxxx] from the homepage you will be redirected to the PT LIMS home screen which provides you with the ability to navigate through the system and undertake several activities from within the header depending on the eligibility of your account.

- **My account** (available to eligible customers)
- **Log out**
- **User Manual**
- **Main Menu**
 - Schemes
 - View schemes
 - Orders (available to eligible customers)
 - Create order for current year

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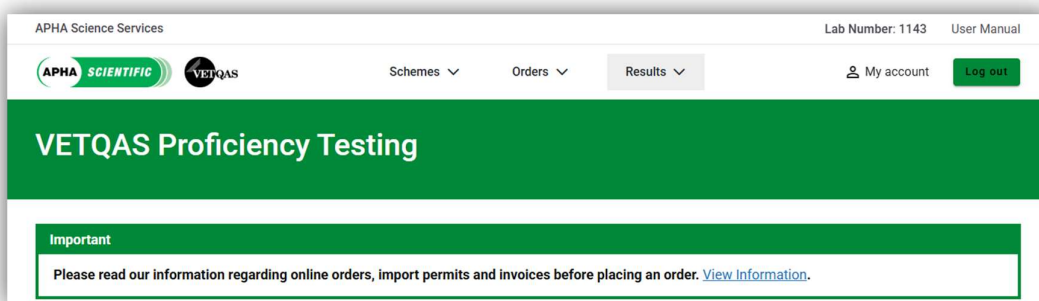




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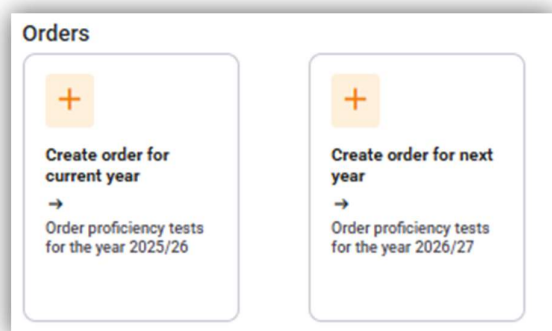


- Create order for next year (available if following years distributions have been renewed by VETQAS)
- Results
 - Enter results
 - View results
- Reports
 - View Reports



Alternatively, participants can use the cards on the homepage to navigate to the desired activity.

CREATING AN ORDER



Request creation of new order for current year - click Create order for current year. This takes you through to the Create new order Page for the current year

Request creation of new order for next year - click Create Order for next year. This takes you through to the Create new order Page for the next year.

Schemes that you are already participating in will appear at the top of the page.

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Home > Create new order

Create new order

For price-lists, including distribution dates, please refer to our [website](#).

QAL Number: QAL/0291

Lab Code: 1143

To participate in a scheme for this year or order additional distributions for a scheme you have already ordered, select the scheme in the first table below. All available months will be selected by default. If you do not want a distribution for a specific month, deselect it.

To participate in a new scheme(s), select the scheme from the commercially available schemes tables. All available months are selected by default. If you do not want a distribution for a specific month, deselect it.

Once you have made all your selections, please select 'Next' at the bottom of this screen.

Please note, you are unable to cancel existing orders from this page. If you wish to do this, please contact us on vetqas@apha.gov.uk

Schemes you participated in last year and/or schemes you are participating in year 2025/26:

Select	Scheme	Scheme Name	Annual Price	Import Permit Required	Postage	Scheme Price	Total
☒	PT0033	ABP Enterobacteriaceae - culture & ID - (Bacteriology)	400.00	☐	£0	£0	£0
		Apr May Jun Jul Aug Sep Oct Nov Dec Jan Feb Mar					
☒	PT0163	Acid alcohol-fast Bacilli (AAFB) - (Bacteriology)	240.00	☐	£0	£0	£0
		Apr May Jun Jul Aug Sep Oct Nov Dec Jan Feb Mar					
☐	PT0001	African Horse Sickness (AHS) - (Serology)	675.00				

All other commercially available schemes are listed below. Users are able to browse these schemes using the search function provided. Selection of 'SHOW ALL' will reset the search term.

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2025/26's commercially available schemes:

Scheme name

SEARCH **SHOW ALL**

Serology

Select	Scheme	Scheme Name	Annual Price	Import Permit Required	Postage	Scheme Price	Total
☐	PT0015	Brucella abortus CFT/SAT - (Serology)	715.00				
☐	PT0016	Brucella abortus ELISA - (Serology)	715.00				
☐	PT0018	Brucella abortus milk - (Serology)	610.00				
☐	PT0019	Brucella abortus Milk Ring Test (MRT) - (Serology)	445.00				
☐	PT0020	Brucella abortus Rose Bengal Test (RBT) - (Serology)	380.00				
☐	PT0022	Brucella canis - (Serology)	430.00				

Bacteriology

Select	Scheme	Scheme Name	Annual Price	Import Permit Required	Postage	Scheme Price	Total
☐	PT0025	Brucella abortus slides - (Bacteriology)	445.00				

Next **Back** **Clear form**

Tick the **Select** box beside the PT Scheme(s) you wish to participate in. Once selected, the available months for the scheme will appear. **Tick** the months you wish to participate in. The postage, scheme price and total will update according to your selections.

If you need to supply us with an import permit, please **tick** the box. Please note that you must provide us with a valid permit a minimum of 7 days before the scheduled delivery, otherwise you risk the order not being fulfilled.

Once you have selected all the schemes you require click **Next** at the bottom of the page which takes you to the Pending Order summary page.

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Pending Order

For price-lists, including distribution dates, please refer to our [website](#).

QAL Number: QAL/0291

Lab Code: 1143

Schemes you have selected:

Scheme	Scheme Name	Full Price	Import Permit Required	Postage	Scheme Price	Total							
PT0001	African Horse Sickness (AHS) - (Serology)	£675.00	☐	£0.00	£675.00	£675.00							
		Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar
			☒						☒			☒	☒
PT0008	Bacterial diseases in cold water fish - (Bacteriology)	£595.00	☐	£0.00	£595.00	£595.00							
		Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar
				☒					☒				

Order details

Contract year: 2026/27

Purchase Order Number:

Scheme Price (£): 1,270.00

Combined Postage (£): 0.00
(Courier, Bio freeze and Dry Ice)

Total Amount (£): 1,270.00

☐ I have read and agreed to the terms and conditions. [View terms and conditions](#)

All the schemes you have selected will be listed for you to review.

Enter a **Purchase Order Number** (if one is required).

The system will combine costs and update your postage automatically. Distributions that are issued on the same date and by the same delivery method that can be shipped together.

If you want to make any changes, click Previous. If you want to return to your order at a later date, click **Save**.

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Once you have viewed and accepted our Terms and Conditions you will be able to submit the order. (You will not be able to click submit until you have accepted the T&Cs). Once your order is completed, please click **Submit**.

We recommend that you **Print** the page before you click **Submit** so that you have a copy for your own record.

Your pending order will be reviewed by the VETQAS team. When the team have approved the order you will receive an email notification as confirmation.

If you would like to know more information about our PT schemes such as prices, distributions dates and any news on schemes [please visit this page](#).

SCHEMES

Schemes



View schemes



List of current
proficiency tests
available

Link to schemes – **click** on View Schemes. This page shows a list of all currently available PT schemes. All the schemes that your Lab ID are participating in are in bold at the top of the list.

RESULTS

Results



Enter results



Submit results for a
current distribution

To submit results for a current distribution – **click** on Enter Results. This takes you to the Current Distributions page. Select the available distribution you want to enter or edit results for, by clicking on **View**.

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This takes you to the Results Entry page. Enter your results then click on **Save** to submit your results (this is very important to avoid losing entered values).

Results entry
16658/BA PT0061: Microbiology - Farm animal - Culture & ID
Over the Test Results below. Tests are divided into Result items which are tested for each Sample, and Method items which apply to the Test itself.
Results can be saved at any time up until the deadline date provided that all the inputs are valid.

Culture

Sample 24/1821	Value	Required format
If specimen not examined please state reason:	Reason for non-examination	X(date)
Intended Pathogen(s) isolated:	Isolated and isolated	X(date)
Would intended pathogen be sent to a ref lab?	Yes	X(date)
Ki Name & Profile for Pathogen (s):	K1821001/01/01/01	X(date)
Other Organisms(s) isolated:	Other Organisms isolated	X(date)
Plating Medium:	Plating Medium	X(date)
Bacteriology Comments:	Bacteriology Comments	X(date)

Sample 24/1822	Value	Required format
If specimen not examined please state reason:		X(date)
Intended Pathogen(s) isolated:		X(date)
Would intended pathogen be sent to a ref lab?	Please Refer	X(date)
Ki Name & Profile for Pathogen (s):		X(date)
Other Organisms(s) isolated:		X(date)
Plating Medium:		X(date)
Bacteriology Comments:		X(date)

Method item	Value	Required format
Date of Receipt:	25/05/2016	dd/mm/yyyy
Date of Testing:		dd/mm/yyyy

If your results have been saved successfully you will be able to see them when you log back into PT LIMS and click on **View** on the Current Distributions page. There will also be a Yes in the Results Entered column.

This screen shot shows an example of an error message you will get if you try to save a result in an incorrect format. You will not be able to save your results successfully until all corrections have been made. There is a brief note next to each entry field with the required format – more details are available by clicking on the **Help** button at the top of the page.

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Method Item	Value	Required format
Date of Receipt	01/01/2026	dd/mm/yyyy
Date of Testing	error	dd/mm/yyyy

Date of Testing must be in format dd/mm/yyyy

Results can be changed or added to up until 23:00hrs (GMT) on the deadline date. After this time the distribution will be locked, and you will not be able to edit your results. If you need to submit additional data sheets or blot images, please email these to vetqas@apha.gov.uk. Make sure that your Lab ID number is quoted on the email and on the attachments.



View results



View your results from
a previous proficiency
test

To view your results from a
previous distribution – click on View
Results.

This takes you to the Previous
Distributions Page. You can use the
Search function to find a particular
distribution or select **Show All**.

Click on **View** to see those results.
This is a 'read-only' page – you
cannot edit results shown

VIEW REPORTS



View reports



View completed
proficiency test reports,
which include all
participant results

View published tabulations of
results – click on View Reports.

This takes you to the Tabulations
Page. Are we referring to them as
'Tabulations' or 'Reports' or a mix
of both?

You can use the **Search** function to
find a particular tabulation or select
Show All.

Click on **View** to see those results.

You can generate a PDF of the Issued Report click **Generate PDF**.

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The report can then be saved and printed.

MY ACCOUNT

Accounts



Edit customer details



Submit an update to
your customer details



Edit participant details



Submit an update to
participating laboratory
details

To update customer and/or invoice
details – click **Edit**

Customer/Invoice Details. This
takes you through to the Edit
Customer Details Page

To update your participant details –
click **Edit Participant Details**. This
takes you through to the Edit
Participant Details Page.

The following will appear:

My account

Contents
→ [Edit participant details](#)
→ [Edit customer/invoice details](#)

Edit participant details

Participant Details
Details of your laboratory participating in proficiency testing
LAB Code: 1143

Contact Name

Organisation Name

Address 1

Address 2

Address 3 (optional)

Address 4 (optional)

Address 5 (optional)

Country

Telephone

Email (Primary)

Email (Secondary) (optional)

My account

Contents
→ [Edit participant details](#)
→ [Edit customer/invoice details](#)

Edit Customer/Invoice details

Customer Details
Please provide details of your laboratory participating in proficiency testing
QAL Number: QAL/0207

Contact Name

Organisation Name

Address 1

Address 2

Address 3 (optional)

Address 4 (optional)

Address 5 (optional)

Country

Telephone

Telephone 2 (optional)

Email

Edit each line as necessary and click **Save** to save your changes.

Once all editing is completed click **Submit**.

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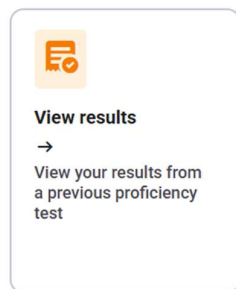
The VETQAS team will then review your changes. You will receive an email notification to confirm that the changes have been processed.

If all the details are correct and no amendments are required - click **Cancel** to exit the page.

Under Participant Details you can now register a primary email address and an optional secondary email address. Both addresses will receive email notifications when, for example, samples have been issued, reports are available, or contact details have been edited. Only the primary email will receive password reset emails.

TEST COMMENTATOR

VIEW REPORTS



To view your results from a previous distribution – click on View Results.

This takes you to the Previous Distributions Page. You can use the **Search** function to find a particular distribution or select **Show All**.

Click on **View** to see those results. This is a 'read-only' page – you cannot edit results shown.

You can generate a PDF of the Issued Report click Generate PDF.

The report can then be saved and printed.

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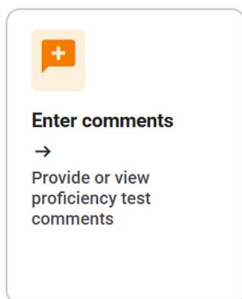




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ENTER COMMENTS



To enter comments when you are the dedicated Test Commentator—click on Enter Comments.

This takes you to the Distributions Page. You can use the **Search** function to find a particular distribution or select **Show All**.

Click on **View** to see those results. This page will provide you with the ability to add comments to a current distribution.

You can view the Distribution by sample number, selecting the relevant drop-down arrow.

RESULTS REPORT

FULL REPORT

ADDITIONAL SAMPLE INFORMATION

PCR

Method items

Sample 19/7011

PCR	BVDV type 1/2	CT values	Interpretation (+ve/-ve/IC)
Intended	Negative		
			-ve
1049		40.00	-ve
1081	n/a	>40	-ve
1113	N/A	No CT	-ve
1140		No Ct	-ve
1170		NA	-ve
1189	Nil Return		
1246			-ve
1525		No CT	-ve

Below the results there is a text box for you to add your comments on the Distribution. You will need to tick the checkbox before being allowed to submit your comments. Once the comments have been submitted, you will be unable to make any changes.

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Add your comments here:

↩ ↪ **B** *I* U x^2 x_2

This %\$*&*()-_+++=!";' \?/.,>< is the new comments text for a distribution

p

☐ I understand that once my comments are submitted, you will not be able to edit them.

SUBMIT SAVE CANCEL

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VIEWERS

VIEW REPORTS

Results



View reports



View completed
proficiency test reports,
which include all
participant results

View published tabulations of
results – click on View Tabulations.

This takes you to the Tabulations
Page.

You can use the Search function to
find a particular tabulation or select
Show All.

Click on View to see those results.
This is a 'read-only' page – you
cannot edit results shown.

You can generate a PDF of the Issued Report click Generate PDF.
The report can then be saved and printed.

NOTE: CLIENTS WHO ARE A PARTICIPANT AS WELL AS A REGISTERED VIEWER WILL HAVE A SEPARATE LOGIN USERNAME AND PASSWORD FOR EACH OF THESE FUNCTIONS. PLEASE ENSURE THAT YOU USE THE CORRECT DETAILS TO GAIN ACCESS TO THE RIGHT PAGES. FOR EXAMPLE - IF YOU ACCESS THE WEBSITE USING YOUR VIEWER LOGIN DETAILS, YOU WILL NOT BE ABLE TO ENTER RESULTS.

If you have any questions regarding your PT schemes or samples, please email vetqas@apha.gov.uk.

We can only accept results that are submitted on-line. However, if you are unable to submit on-line, please contact us immediately to discuss.

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PT LIMS will routinely send participants two automated emails for each distribution that they participate in –

1. To notify you when your PT samples have been posted/shipped. *
2. To notify you when the final tabulated report has been published on-line and is available to view.

** If you have not received your PT samples within seven days of the issue date please contact us so that we can investigate.*

You should routinely check your samples on receipt. Please email vetqas@apha.gov.uk immediately if there are any problems with the PT samples you have received.

If you cancel your contract with us, your APHA Science Services account will be locked. You will be unable to access your tabulated reports/results. We will give you seven days' notice before locking your account to give you time to print off any results you may wish to keep for your records.

We value your feedback and comments on any aspect of VETQAS Proficiency Testing (schemes, website etc.) so please do not hesitate to contact us at any time.

Thank you

Head of VETQAS

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